First stop, Royal Lodge. To meet Fergie, because Meg already knew Fergie's daughter Euge, and Jack, so this seemed a logical baby step. But as we neared Royal Lodge I got word on my phone.

Granny was there.

She'd popped in.

On her way from church back to the castle.

Meg said: *Fun! I love grandmas.*

I asked if she knew how to curtsy. She said she thought so. But she also couldn't tell if I was serious.

You're about to meet the Queen.

I know, but it's your grandma.

But she's the Queen.

We pulled into the driveway, drove across the gravel, parked next to the big green box hedge.

Fergie came outside, somewhat aflutter, and said: *Do you know how to curtsy?*

Meg shook her head.

Fergie demonstrated once. Meg imitated her.

There wasn't time for a more advanced tutorial. We couldn't keep Granny waiting.

As we walked towards the door Fergie and I both leaned into Meg, whispering quick reminders. *When you first meet the Queen it's Your Majesty. Thereafter it's just Ma'am. Rhymes with ham.*

Just, whatever you do, don't talk over her, we both said, talking over each other.

We entered the large front sitting room and there she was. Granny. The monarch. Queen Elizabeth II. Standing in the middle of the room. She turned slightly. Meg went straight to her and dropped a deep, flawless curtsy.

Your Majesty. Pleasure to meet you.

Euge and Jack were near Granny and they almost seemed to pretend not to know Meg. They were very quiet, very proper. Each gave Meg a quick kiss on the cheek, but it was pure royal. Pure British.

There was some bloke standing to the other side of Granny and I thought: Bogey at twelve o'clock. Meg looked to me for a clue as to his identity, but I